Humana

Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Ordering/Referring Provider Requirements

Application: Medicare Advantage and Medicaid Products
Policy number: CP2015002
Related policies: Modifier EY

Published date: 03/2017
Revision Date: 07/2026

Disclaimer*: The intended audience of this medical claims payment policy is healthcare providers who treat Humana members. This policy is made available to provide information on certain Humana claims payment processes. This policy is a guideline only and does not constitute medical advice, guarantee of payment, plan pre-authorization, an explanation of benefits, or a contract. This policy does not govern whether a procedure is covered under a specific member plan or policy, nor is it intended to address every claim situation. Claims may be affected by other factors, such as: state and federal laws and regulations, provider contract terms, and our professional judgment. This policy is subject to change or termination by Humana. Humana has full and final discretionary authority for its interpretation and application. No part of this policy may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any shape or form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying or otherwise without express written permission from Humana. When printed, this version becomes uncontrolled. For the most current information, always refer to the following website:* ***Humana.com/ClaimPaymentPolicies***

Overview

Section 1833(q) of the Social Security Act requires charges for some Medicare Program services to be submitted with ordering or *referring* provider information from a *qualified healthcare provider*. This requirement ensures quality of care because many services require a *qualified healthcare provider* to interpret and provide guidance to the patient. Supplying a valid National Provider Identifier (NPI) of the ordering or *referring qualified healthcare provider* helps in the verification that services rendered were necessary and medically reviewed and that follow-up care is available.

Original Medicare began rejecting claims without valid ordering or *referring* provider information January 6, 2014.

Medicare Advantage Payment Policy
Medicaid Payment Policy
Definitions of *Italicized* Terms
References
General Humana Resources

Claims Payment Policy
Subject: Ordering/Referring Provider Requirements
Policy Number: CP2015002

Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Valid Order or *Referral* Requirement

Humana plans require valid orders for the same types of services for which Original Medicare requires orders and require valid *referrals* for the same types of services for which Original Medicare requires *referrals*. To be valid, an order or *referral* must have been issued by a *qualified healthcare provider*.

The services of a Part A home health agency, specifically, may only be ordered or *referred* by a doctor of medicine, doctor of osteopathy or doctor of podiatry.

Humana plans deny charges for services for which Humana requires valid orders or *referrals* when those services were provided in the absence of an *applicable,* valid order or *referral*; when appropriate, plans require reimbursement of *overpayments*.

Order or *Referral* Documentation

Humana requires providers to maintain complete and accurate documentation of orders and *referrals* for services for which Humana requires orders and *referrals*. Humana requires providers to make order and *referral* documentation available to Humana upon request. Humana plans deny charges for services that lack appropriate order or *referral* documentation; when appropriate, plans require reimbursement of *overpayments*.

Claim Submission

A charge for a service that requires a valid order or *referral* must be submitted with the name and NPI of the ordering or *referring* provider, that provider must be a *qualified healthcare provider*, and that provider's name and NPI must be accurate and valid. Humana plans deny charges for services that require orders or *referrals* if those charges are not submitted as described herein; when appropriate, plans require reimbursement of *overpayments*.

Examples of Services Requiring an Order or *Referral*

The following are examples of services that require ordering or *referring* provider information as described above. This is not an all-inclusive list.

- Durable medical equipment, prosthetics, orthotics and supplies (DMEPOS)
- Clinical laboratory and pathology services
- Radiology services

Medicaid Payment Policy

Humana expects providers to follow the respective state Medicaid agency ordering and *referring* provider requirements. Humana Medicaid plans allow charges for services consistent with state Medicaid guidelines regarding ordering and *referring* provider requirements.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Applicable***: An order or referral is applicable to rendered services when those services were provided pursuant to that order or referral.
- ***Overpayments***: Amounts paid to the provider for services that lack documentation.

- ***Qualified healthcare provider***: As used herein, means an individual licensed as one of the following: dental surgeon, doctor of medicine, doctor of osteopathy, doctor of dental medicine, doctor of podiatry, optometrist (may only order DME, laboratory and X-ray services), nurse practitioner, physician assistant, certified clinical nurse specialist, clinical psychologist, intern, resident, fellow, certified nurse midwife and clinical social worker.
- ***Refer/referral***: As used herein, means the process of a qualified healthcare provider directing work to another provider. This is also known as "certifying." It is thus distinct from the way that term might be used in any other contexts to describe the process established by the health plan to authorize outpatient specialty care services or inpatient services not rendered by the member's primary care physician.

References

- Social Security Administration website. Social Security Act. Title 18, Section 1833. www.ssa.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 1 – General Billing Requirements. Section 80.3.2 – Handling Incomplete or Invalid Claims. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Ordering & Certifying. www.cms.gov.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

Note: Links to sources outside of Humana's control are verified at the time of publication. Please report broken links.